

Moonsea Rising - 20240310

The Sea Cave

Aboard the ship Harken has found them, Beitris alerts them to the coastline from her vision. The captain, promising to wait for further pay, allows them to use a dinghy, and they set out into the small cave, barely visible from the boat.

In the cave, they find a small cave, that ends after a few feet. Below the water, however, stairs extended into the water. Sighing, Lirael digs the shell of easy breathing out of the portable hole, and starts filling it. She tells the others that the sea elves have temples to Damoden all throughout the Moonsea. Though she knows little of the worship of the sea god, she knows that his worshipers are often friendly with the sea life around them. Taevyn starts snapping on some small fins.

As they fill their lungs with the magical bubbles and enter the water, they tread briefly before angling downwards. Harken has a magic lantern, and they stay close to the bubble of light around him.

Entering a hallway at the base of the steps, they find several doors and a hallway branching off. Taevyn motions to the nearest door, graven with a large, open-mouthed, sea creature, to ask if it's a Damodrite icon. Lirael is unaware, and he and Lennox enter the room to find a kind of dressing room, full of decaying wooden lockers and scraps of cloth.

As they move through the room to open the other door, a school of glowing blue fish swim from the room and towards the southern hallway. In the room, Taevyn and Lennox find a corroded chest. Lennox attempt to hack it with his axe, finding that an axe isn't very useful underwater.

However, the chest smashes easily enough, and a jellied tentacle lashes out at him. Lirael catches the movement, and throws her spear quickly at it, catching it two blows, though the slime seems not very impacted by the spear pokes. Harken peppers it with the shards of its smashed chest, slashing at it, but it absorbs most of the impact.

The pseudopod lashes out around Lennox, wrapping him up and squeezing him. He quickly breaks the creature's grasp, and smashes it with his axe, though it seems ineffective. Taevyn considers, and points his ring of the dark sun at the creature. Magicks blast it, pummelling the slime.

Lirael moves around Taevyn and fires a ray of frost into the creature, which strikes it freezing a large patch of its surface. It immediately moves to try and get away, though it has limited options. Harken messages Lennox to disengage from it, and allow it flee. Lennox instead smashes it with the side of the axe, and throws a punch, neither of which it's pleased with.

Taevyn does some kind of complicated aquatic manuver that the effect of distracting the creature, but otherwise is of limited impact. Lirael tells Lennox to let it leave and clears the doorway. She readies another ray of frost, in case it doesn't flee. Harken tries to open the other door, but finds it locked. The slime tries to flee, dodging Lennox's kick as it goes.

In the remainder of the chest lies a key that fits the door lock to the next room. Harken checks for traps, and gestures everyone back while he opens the door. They find a massive room, extending well beyond the light of Harken's lantern. The vaulted ceiling is obscured by seven-foot tall sea grasses, and a large statue with a open-mawed fishy statue of some description looms against the north wall. As Harken swims towards the ceiling to search the grass, Taevyn swims to observe the statue. Visions fill his mind of a non-Euclidean space filled with a malevolent presence.

The Sunken Horror

As he gapes at it, it begins to move, reaching out for him and the others. Taevyn attempts to tumble past it, stabbing it as it tries to take command of his mind. He is stunned by the enormity of its malice, but fights off the intrusion. Beitris summons her spiritual weapon, which smash into the thing, harming it. With uncharacteristic abandon, she moves closer to the thing, preparing some protective magicks. Harken starts flashing his lantern at the statue, trying to distract it, before drawing an arrow from his quiver and using his psychic powers to propel it forward. Lennox swims forward, slowly swinging his axe through the water. He chops into it heavily twice, leaving it near death. Lirael considers the creature, but nothing obvious presents itself about the thing, and she fires the ray of frost at it. It compresses inexplicably, angles shifting through one another, and leaves onto the original statue behind. Among the rubble, a very fine magical crossbow with ice runes is found, which Taevyn eyes before hanging on his belt.

Lirael asks Beitris if any of the icons mean anything to her, but she has limited knowledge of the sea gods. Taevyn checks one of the side rooms, which appears to be filled with some kind of blackish brine, but is otherwise empty. Swimming back, he and Lennox open the far door, revealing a room swarming with sea spiders of some sort.

He immediately slams the door, leaning his back against it. Swimming to the south, he opens the last door, finding a room full of giant crawfish. They are gathered around the far door, but are easily dispatched by Lennox and Taevyn.

The Final Harken

They open the far door, revealing an alter, with another massive fish head behind it, the open mouth disappearing into darkness. From the darkness, a long eel-like creature comes forward, snapping a chunk out of Taevyn, and coiling around him, and pulling him back into the hole.

Lennox swims after them, grabbing Taevyn's feet and pulling backwards. Harken swims forward to help, but the eel manages to swallow him whole. Beitris watches in horror as the eel prepares to retreat with its meal. A lance of divine light flashes out from her, missing the eel.

Taevyn wriggles around, kicking and stabbing with his dagger, and manages to get the beast to disgorge him. He holds up his rapier to parry further strikes. Lirael swims into the room, using ray of frost again, since that has been very effective against the sea life. Lennox lashes out at it with his axe, but the eel is slippery, and he manages to miss it.

Harken tries to dig his dagger into the eel, to prevent it from retracting into its hole. It bites at him, preventing his attempt to pin its jaw with his dagger, and it he follows it up with his telekinesis. It

lashes out at him, biting deeply into his torso. It coils around him, and swallows him. Beitris flashes another divine lance, the light slashing at the eel. Taevyn does another fancy underwater maneuver, rapier flashing and missing in the water. Lirael flashes out the ray of frost, throwing the spear after, but the latter misses.

Lennox continues chopping at the beast, trying to free Harken. He lands a single solid chop, but otherwise misses. Harken uses his telekinesis from within the thing's gullet, and tries to wriggle backwards, unsuccessfully. He loses consciousness as the eel's muscles work to break him down. Beitris tries to hit it with divine lance again, but misses as Taevyn slashes at it repeatedly. Lirael moves forward, trying to get him free with the spear, but is unable to hit the eel.

Lennox continues chopping at the eel, but only manages to connect once. Inside of the eel, out of view of the party, Harken succumbs to his fate, the gods granting him his peace. In the back of his psyche, he reaches out, cursing this place and the beast that consumed him as his spirit departs the plane.

Beitris continues using divine lance, spirit damage lashing the beast, desperate to free Harken. Taevyn spins, rapier flashing, as he filets the beast, killing it.

Beitris moves to it, chopping with the kukri, as Harken's body floats lifelessly from the eel. Tears mixing with the salt water, she takes some of his corpse for restoration purposes.

Lirael talks to General Tuskclaw, asking him if there is anything he can do. He says not, then corrects that there is nothing worth doing. She pushes, asking him what Gruumsh can do. He remains silent.